

# Cultivating the fields of God

A fundamental field guide for God's labourers

Labouring in God's fields is **not** a specific calling amongst reborn humans. It is a general duty that applies to all those saved from the wrath to come ([Ecclesiastes 12:13,14](#)). To learn more about spiritual gifts that are given to each of us as needed and why, study [Ephesians 4:11,12](#) and [1 Corinthians 12:4-11](#).

Luke 9:61-62

<sup>61</sup> And another also said, Lord, I will follow thee; but let me first go bid them farewell, which are at home at my house. <sup>62</sup> And Jesus said unto him, **No man, having put his hand to the plough, and looking back, is fit for the kingdom of God.**

- The old man is dead, don't bother looking back. Rather, look forward, running with patience the race that is set before you ([Romans 6:7,11,17,18](#), [2 Corinthians 5:17](#)).
  - The wicked will relentlessly bombard you with your past. Remind them of the truth:
    - That man is dead and a dead man is freed from sin.
    - You are no longer a servant to sin.
    - The blood of Jesus Christ which cleanseth us from all unrighteousness is still on the altar ([Hebrews 10:10](#)).
- Jesus refers to a saved individual here as a person that operates a "plough". Other names for a person that operates a plough/plow are: sower, farmer, husbandman ([Genesis 9:20](#)).

John 4:35

**Say not ye, There are yet four months, and then cometh harvest? behold, I say unto you, Lift up your eyes, and look on the fields; for they are white already to harvest.**

- Four months before the "white harvest" (wheat) places this conversation in winter (December/January).
  - Side note: This is the most likely reason that the Samaritan woman was at the well at noon (also known as the heat of the day and the sixth hour, [John 11:9](#)) instead of the cool of the day (morning or evening). The temperature range for that region in winter is 45-60F during the day.
- But, Jesus said the fields are ready to harvest now. The wheat would not be ready for another four months so what fields were ready to harvest?
- He was talking about the fields of God's husbandry which are people.

John 15:1

<sup>1</sup> **I am the true vine, and my Father is the husbandman.**

1 Corinthians 3:6-11

<sup>6</sup> **I have planted, Apollos watered; but God gave the increase.**<sup>7</sup> So then neither is he that planteth any thing, neither he that watereth; but God that giveth the increase.<sup>8</sup> Now he that planteth and he that watereth are one: and every man shall receive his own reward according to his own labour.<sup>9</sup> **For we are labourers together with God: ye are God's husbandry, ye are God's building.**<sup>10</sup> According to the grace of God which is given unto me, as a wise masterbuilder, I have laid the foundation, and another buildeth thereon. But let every man take heed how he buildeth thereupon.<sup>11</sup> For other foundation can no man lay than that is laid, which is Jesus Christ.

John 4:36-37

<sup>36</sup> **And he that reapeth receiveth wages, and gathereth fruit unto life eternal: that both he that soweth and he that reapeth may rejoice together.**<sup>37</sup> **And herein is that saying true, One soweth, and another reapeth.**

- We are labourers (husbandman) with God.
- We are also His field, building, and temple ([Ephesians 2:10a](#), [1 Corinthians 3:16](#)).
- Just like the seeds we plant, fertilize, and water in our garden so too is the word of God and the people we share it with. How they grow is of the Lord of the harvest.
- There are at least three jobs for labourers in the fields of God:
  - Plowing and Planting (sowing)
    - Seeds (the word of God)
  - Watering
    - Every plant needs a regular supply of water throughout it's entire life
  - Reaping
    - Fruit produced from plants within the fields that others benefit from

Jesus gives us a practical example of a spiritual truth: going to the market and buying food.

John 4:38

**I sent you to reap that whereon ye bestowed no labour: other men laboured, and ye are entered into their labours.**

The parable of the Sower

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| <p>Matthew 13:3-8</p> <p><sup>3</sup> And he spake many things unto them in parables, saying, Behold, a sower went forth to sow;</p> <p><sup>4</sup> And when he sowed, some seeds fell by the way side, and the fowls came and devoured them up:</p> <p><sup>5</sup> Some fell upon stony places, where they had not much earth: and forthwith they sprung up, because they had no deepness of earth:</p> <p><sup>6</sup> And when the sun was up, they were scorched; and because they had no root, they withered away.</p> <p><sup>7</sup> And some fell among thorns; and the thorns sprang up, and choked them:</p> <p><sup>8</sup> But other fell into good ground, and brought forth fruit, some an hundredfold, some sixtyfold, some thirtyfold.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <p>Mark 4:3-8</p> <p><sup>3</sup> Hearken; Behold, there went out a sower to sow:</p> <p><sup>4</sup> And it came to pass, as he sowed, some fell by the way side, and the fowls of the air came and devoured it up.</p> <p><sup>5</sup> And some fell on stony ground, where it had not much earth; and immediately it sprang up, because it had no depth of earth:</p> <p><sup>6</sup> But when the sun was up, it was scorched; and because it had no root, it withered away.</p> <p><sup>7</sup> And some fell among thorns, and the thorns grew up, and choked it, and it yielded no fruit.</p> <p><sup>8</sup> And other fell on good ground, and did yield fruit that sprang up and increased; and brought forth, some thirty, and some sixty, and some an hundred.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <p>Luke 8:5-8</p> <p><sup>5</sup> A sower went out to sow his seed: and as he sowed, some fell by the way side; and it was trodden down, and the fowls of the air devoured it.</p> <p><sup>6</sup> And some fell upon a rock; and as soon as it was sprung up, it withered away, because it lacked moisture.</p> <p><sup>7</sup> And some fell among thorns; and the thorns sprang up with it, and choked it.</p> <p><sup>8</sup> And other fell on good ground, and sprang up, and bare fruit an hundredfold. And when he had said these things, he cried, He that hath ears to hear, let him hear.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <p>Matthew 13:18-23</p> <p><sup>18</sup> Hear ye therefore the parable of the sower.</p> <p><sup>19</sup> When any one heareth the word of the kingdom, and understandeth it not, then cometh the wicked one, and catcheth away that which was sown in his heart. This is he which received seed by the way side.</p> <p><sup>20</sup> But he that received the seed into stony places, the same is he that heareth the word, and anon with joy receiveth it;</p> <p><sup>21</sup> Yet hath he not root in himself, but dureth for a while: for when tribulation or persecution ariseth because of the word, by and by he is offended.</p> <p><sup>22</sup> He also that received seed among the thorns is he that heareth the word; and the care of this world, and the deceitfulness of riches, choke the word, and he becometh unfruitful.</p> <p><sup>23</sup> But he that received seed into the good ground is he that heareth the word, and understandeth it; which also beareth fruit, and bringeth forth, some an hundredfold, some sixty, some thirty.</p> | <p>Mark 4:13-20</p> <p><sup>13</sup> And he said unto them, Know ye not this parable? and how then will ye know all parables?</p> <p><sup>14</sup> The sower soweth the word.</p> <p><sup>15</sup> And these are they by the way side, where the word is sown; but when they have heard, Satan cometh immediately, and taketh away the word that was sown in their hearts.</p> <p><sup>16</sup> And these are they likewise which are sown on stony ground; who, when they have heard the word, immediately receive it with gladness;</p> <p><sup>17</sup> And have no root in themselves, and so endure but for a time: afterward, when affliction or persecution ariseth for the word's sake, immediately they are offended.</p> <p><sup>18</sup> And these are they which are sown among thorns; such as hear the word,</p> <p><sup>19</sup> And the cares of this world, and the deceitfulness of riches, and the lusts of other things entering in, choke the word, and it becometh unfruitful.</p> <p><sup>20</sup> And these are they which are sown on good ground; such as hear the word, and receive it, and bring forth fruit, some thirtyfold, some sixty, and some an hundred.</p> | <p>Luke 8:11-15</p> <p><sup>11</sup> Now the parable is this: The seed is the word of God.</p> <p><sup>12</sup> Those by the way side are they that hear; then cometh the devil, and taketh away the word out of their hearts, lest they should believe and be saved.</p> <p><sup>13</sup> They on the rock are they, which, when they hear, receive the word with joy; and these have no root, which for a while believe, and in time of temptation fall away.</p> <p><sup>14</sup> And that which fell among thorns are they, which, when they have heard, go forth, and are choked with cares and riches and pleasures of this life, and bring no fruit to perfection.</p> <p><sup>15</sup> But that on the good ground are they, which in an honest and good heart, having heard the word, keep it, and bring forth fruit with patience.</p> |

- The seed that is to be sowed is the word of God.
  - And it must be spoken so that another can hear it.
- To speak the word of God we need to know the word of God.
  - This requires work but it is not as hard as the devil may want you to believe nor is it as complicated as you might imagine.
- The parable of the Sower teaches us what types of ground we can expect to encounter when sowing (and more).

The foundation for memorizing God’s written word is nothing more than repetition ([Isaiah 28:9,10](#)). Be not deceived: that is all there is to it. We can use whatever form of repetition works for us (I would recommend a mix of all of them!). Here are a few common examples but always remember that no matter which method you choose the foundation of successful memorization will always be repetition:

- Writing it
- Singing it
- Reading it
- Speaking it
- Trivia

[Isaiah 28:9,10](#)  
<sup>9</sup> Whom shall he teach knowledge? and whom shall he make to understand doctrine? them that are weaned from the milk, and drawn from the breasts.  
<sup>10</sup> For precept **must be** upon precept, precept upon precept; line upon line, line upon line; **here a little**, and **there a little**:

- This is the key to how we memorize anything: good or bad.
- Any other temptation not based on this God’s word is deception.

**WARNING!**

**Do not** let the wicked get you down because you don’t have all of God’s written word memorized! **Do not** let them get you anxious or nervous about it either! God already knew that we would have this infirmity before He created us and He is faithful: [1 Corinthians 10:13](#).

First, know that not all of God’s word is written. Here’s how we can prove that with God’s word:

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| <a href="#">Matthew 4:4</a><br>But he answered and said, <b>It is written, Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God.</b> | <a href="#">Luke 4:4</a><br>And Jesus answered him, saying, <b>It is written, That man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word of God.</b> |
| The spoken word of God                                                                                                                                                       | The written word of God                                                                                                                             |

Ok, so you have your King James Bible which is the written word of God. So, how do we receive or prove the spoken word of God? The Holy Ghost: [John 14:26, 16:13](#).

[Isaiah 55:10,11](#)  
<sup>10</sup> For as the rain cometh down, and the snow from heaven, and returneth not thither, but watereth the earth, and maketh it bring forth and bud, that it may give seed to the sower, and bread to the eater:  
<sup>11</sup> So shall **my word** be **that goeth forth out of my mouth**: it shall not return unto me void, but it shall accomplish that which I please, and it shall prosper in the thing whereto I sent it.

- God gives us (the sower) seed (His spoken word) for His fields through the Holy Ghost.

But, there’s a lot to the word of God! Not only are there 31,102 verses in the written word but He can speak to us as well. So, how do we know which seed goes into which field, when, where, and how? The same way we get the seed: from the written and spoken word of God.

[2 Timothy 3:16-17](#)  
<sup>16</sup> All scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness: <sup>17</sup> **That the man of God may be perfect, thoroughly furnished unto all good works.**

[Isaiah 28:23-29](#)  
<sup>23</sup> Give ye ear, and hear my voice; hearken, and **hear** my speech.  
<sup>24</sup> Doth the plowman plow all day to sow? doth he open and break the clods of his ground?  
<sup>25</sup> When he hath made plain the face thereof, doth he not cast abroad the **fitches**, and scatter the **cummin**, and cast in the principal **wheat** and the appointed **barley** and the **rie** in their place?  
<sup>26</sup> **For his God doth instruct him to discretion, and doth teach him.**  
<sup>27</sup> For the fitches are not threshed with a threshing instrument, neither is a cart wheel turned about upon the cummin; but the fitches are beaten out with a staff, and the cummin with a rod.  
<sup>28</sup> Bread corn is bruised; because he will not ever be threshing it, nor break it with the wheel of his cart, nor bruise it with his horsemen.  
<sup>29</sup> This also cometh forth from the LORD of hosts, which is wonderful in counsel, and excellent in working.

- Verse 26 makes it plainly clear how we know and are taught which seeds go where.

And as if that wasn't enough, God gives us exceedingly abundantly above all that we could ask for:

1 Peter 4:11  
If any man speak, let him speak as the oracles of God; if any man minister, let him do it as of the ability which God giveth: that God in all things may be glorified through Jesus Christ, to whom be praise and dominion for ever and ever. Amen.

- To “speak as” is the same as to “speak like”.
- The oracles of God is the written word of God (Acts 7:38, Romans 3:2).
- For example: “Murder is evil”. The word of God does not say exactly that, so then we are speaking “like” the word of God because:
  - Not doing well in the eyes of the LORD is sin (Genesis 4:7)
  - Murder is the same as killing (Matthew 5:21,22)
  - We are commanded to not kill (Exodus 20:13, Deuteronomy 5:17)
  - And sin is evil
    - Genesis 50:17 (the same actions of Joseph’s brethren towards him are called two different words which is a parallelism that also teaches us that sin is evil)

And with all of that we have the fundamentals of labouring in the fields of God.

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| <p>Matthew 9:37-38</p> <p><sup>37</sup> Then saith he unto his disciples, The harvest truly is plenteous, but the labourers are few; <sup>38</sup> Pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest, that he will send forth labourers into his harvest.</p> | <p>Luke 10:2</p> <p>Therefore said he unto them, The harvest truly is great, but the labourers are few: pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest, that he would send forth labourers into his harvest.</p> |
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